

French A1 — Week 3 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 3

Theme: Regular Verbs and Daily Routine

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 3 introduces the most useful grammar pattern in French: the regular *-er* verb.

About 90% of French verbs follow this pattern. Once you learn it, you can conjugate hundreds of verbs — *parler*, *habiter*, *travailler*, *écouter*, *regarder*, *manger*, *étudier* — with the same six endings. You will also learn how to make sentences negative (*ne...pas*) and how to say how often you do things.

By the end of Week 3, you will be able to talk about your daily life in French.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 3

By the end of Session 6, you should be able to say something like:

Le matin, je me lève vers sept heures. Je travaille de neuf heures à dix-sept heures. Je mange souvent à la maison le soir. Je regarde parfois une série ou j'écoute de la musique. Je ne travaille jamais le dimanche.

You will also be able to describe others:

Ma collègue s'appelle Sarah. Elle parle anglais et espagnol. Elle travaille dans le marketing. Elle n'habite pas à Paris — elle habite à Lyon.

The *-er* Verb Pattern

Here it is in full for *parler* (to speak):

Subject	Form
je	parle
tu	parles
il / elle	parle
nous	parlons
vous	parlez
ils / elles	parlent

The most important thing to know: The first four forms (*je*, *tu*, *il*, *ils*) all sound the same in spoken French — only *parlons* and *parlez* are distinct when you hear them. This is not an error — it is how French works. Context and the subject pronoun tell your listener which person you mean.

One Thing That Surprises Students This Week

In English, "I eat" and "I don't eat" are very different. In French, the difference is just two words wrapped around the verb: *Je mange* → *Je **ne** mange **pas***.

The tricky part: in everyday French speech, the *ne* is often dropped. You will hear *Je mange pas de viande* from native speakers. But in writing, and in class, always keep both halves: *Je ne mange pas de viande*.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 5 — before Session 6:

1. **Say the -er verb endings from memory.** -e, -es, -e, -ons, -ez, -ent. Say them ten times with *parler* as your model verb. Then try one more verb.
2. **Write 5 sentences about yourself.** Use 5 different verbs from the week. Include one negative.
3. **Say your sentences out loud.** Close your notes on the second try.

After Session 6 — before Session 7:

1. **Write your daily routine.** 5–6 sentences, using sequencing words (*d'abord, puis, ensuite, enfin*) and time expressions (*le matin, le soir, à + hour*).
 2. **Add frequency.** At least two sentences should include a frequency word: *souvent, parfois, rarement, jamais*.
 3. **Say it out loud.** Aim to deliver the whole routine without notes on your third try.
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A Note on Mistakes

You will mix up endings. You will forget *ne* in negative sentences. You will say *je parles* instead of *je parle*. These are all expected errors at Week 3 — they are the errors your instructor is watching for so they can be corrected before they become habits.

The only way to get the pattern into muscle memory is to say it out loud, get it wrong, hear the correction, and say it again. That is the process. It is not a sign that you are struggling — it is exactly what learning looks like at A1.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 4

See the full list in your Week 3 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 7 are:

- All six -er verb endings from memory
 - The 8 core verbs in their *je, tu, il/elle* forms at minimum
 - Ne...pas in a sentence — both the written rule and the spoken drop
 - 3 frequency words (*souvent, parfois, jamais*) and how they position in a sentence
 - 4–5 sequencing words for describing a routine (*d'abord, puis, ensuite, enfin*)
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Crescere — French A1 Week 3 | Questions? Contact your instructor.